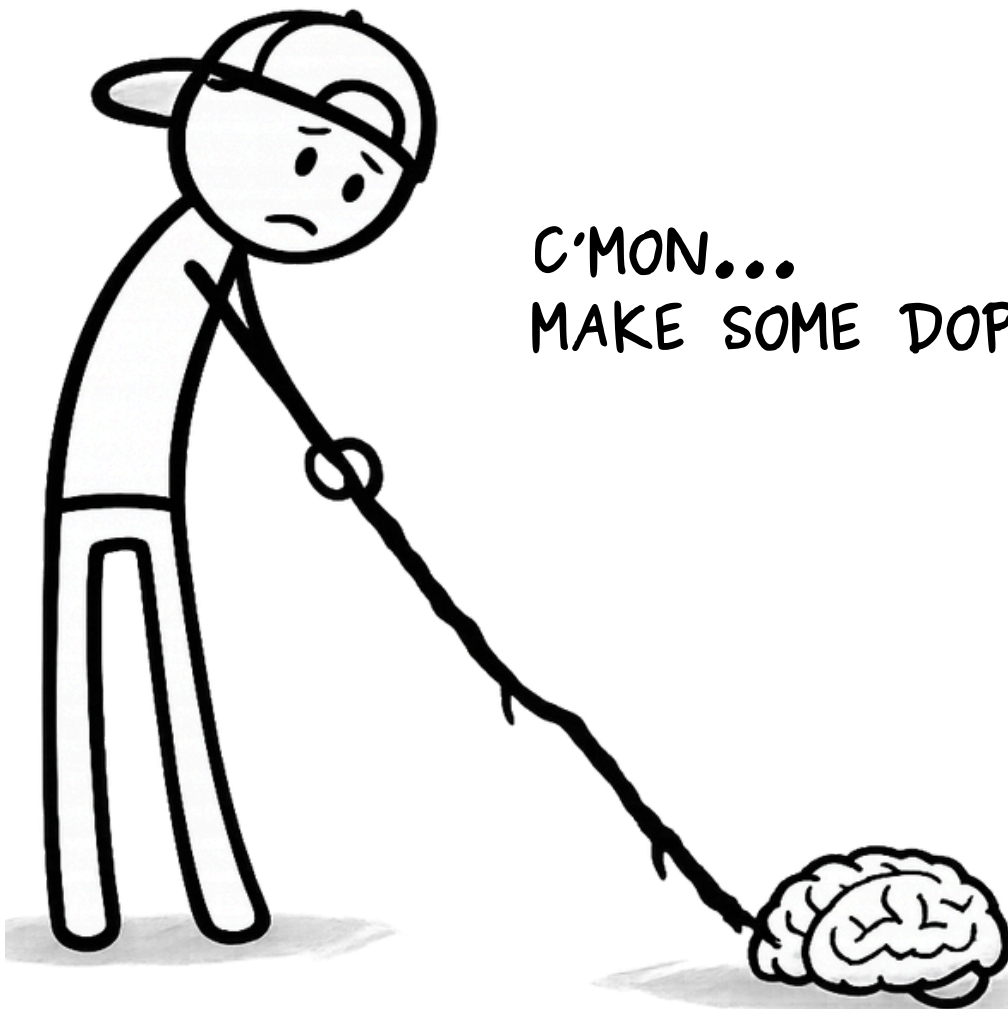




DOPAMINE

CHEAT SHEET



C'MON...
MAKE SOME DOPAMINE.



DOPAMINE IS AWESOME, ACTUALLY.

Everyone talks about dopamine like it's the villain. Like it's the reason we're distracted, addicted, and struggle to focus. In reality, dopamine is actually a great thing. Think of it like your brain's fuel. No dopamine, no drive. Low dopamine, everything feels hard and pointless. The right amount of dopamine at the right time? You feel locked in and unstoppable. It's released when you do something rewarding — finishing a task, eating something good, hitting a goal, even just anticipating something exciting.

The problem we have – including me, you, your parents, teachers, everyone – phones, sugar, late nights, and endless scrolling have been draining our tanks on things that don't matter... which leaves nothing left for the things that do.

THE SEVEN TIPS WILL HELP YOU HACK YOUR BRAIN AND START USING YOUR DOPAMINE WHERE IT ACTUALLY COUNTS!

AND STILL PLAY YOUR FAV VIDEO GAME OR SCROLL! CUZ THOSE THINGS ROCK.





TIP #1: SET THE VIBE

To make it easier to work hard, you need to **create an environment that doesn't suck**. Your brain releases dopamine in response to positive cues like the music playing, the smell of your favorite drink, the comfort of your favorite hoodie or your dog at the end of your bed. The more cozy your environment is, the less horrible your task will feel. When you take **5 minutes** to set up a cozy work environment, you're priming your brain to actually begin!

REAL LIFE EXAMPLES TO SET THE VIBE

- Your fav playlist
- Movie soundtracks
- Good smelling candle
- Decluttered desk
- Colorful highlighters
- Dog cuddled next to you
- Cup of green tea
- Warm lighting (or neon!)
- PB&J sandwich



TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

Write down 3-5 things that would make your **workspace** feel better. Playlist, drink, lighting, scent, comfort item. Use those things every time.

Set your vibe before you start homework. **Vibe first**. Work second.

Create a dedicated **focus playlist** that only plays during work. Over time your brain will associate it with focus and lock in automatically.

Make your favorite **hot drink** and drink it while you work.



TIP #2: FIND LEVEL 1

You won't get dopamine or feel motivation until you see a win coming. When you look at a massive project, your **dopamine flatlines because the reward feels too far away**.

To hack your dopamine, stop trying to start on Level 10. Find the smallest possible first step – **aka your Level 1** – and your dopamine will kick in just enough to move. Complete it, get the dopamine hit, then move to Level 2. The snowball starts rolling from there. In short, **momentum leads to motivation**, rarely the other way around.

REAL LIFE EXAMPLES OF FINDING LEVEL 1

Write my essay

Write intro paragraph

Clean my room

Pick 3 things up off floor

Put away my clothes

Put away underwear

Finish my project

Spend 5 min on project

Start a business

Create business name

TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

Before starting anything, ask yourself: **"What is my Level 1?"** Write it down. and do only that first. You can't beat the final boss without completing level 1.

When you feel stressed, set a 2 minute timer. Just do Level 1 for 2 minutes. You'll almost always keep going.

Break your next big project into 10 micro-tasks. Make each one so small it feels almost too easy. This creates momentum and momentum fuels motivation.



TIP #3: BORING BREAKS WIN

Most people take breaks wrong. You finish a hard task, open TikTok, and spend 20 minutes scrolling. It feels like a rest, but it's not..

You just **flooded** your brain with more dopamine hits, so now sitting back down to work feels impossible. **Your brain is fried.**

A quality break is boring on purpose. No phone, no show, no dopamine spikes. It sounds terrible, but it works every time. The more boring your break, the better your brain **comes back**.

REAL LIFE EXAMPLES BORING BREAKS

Scroll TikTok for "just 5 minutes"

Watch a YouTube video

Check Instagram real quick

Text your friends back

Turn on Netflix in the background

Make a healthy snack

Stare at a **wall** (seriously)

Take a walk without your phone

Play with your **dog**

Take a **shower** (bonus if it's cold)

TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

For your next 3 study breaks, leave your phone face down. Walk around, play with your dog, maybe make a healthy snack and grab some water.

Notice how you feel after a boring break vs. a scrolling break. The difference will convince you more than anything else. Self awareness is key.

The future belongs to those who can be bored without filling time and space with stimulation. The earlier you master it, the earlier you'll win



TIP #4: ONE SCREEN RULE

Have you ever caught yourself **watching** YouTube on the TV, scrolling on your phone, and online shopping on a computer? All at the **same time**?

I do it all the time. It's horrible for our brains. At the end of the day, **diluted focus gets diluted results**.

Make a **rule** that you're only allowed to have **one screen** at a time. It will save your dopamine levels.

REAL LIFE EXAMPLES ONE SCREEN RULE

This is pretty self explanatory. Just use one screen at a time and don't be like this guy lol



TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

Put your phone in a different room for your next study session. Not face down.. different room!

Try one homework session with no background TV or videos. Music is fine, but moving images are not.

When you're watching TV, watch TV! Don't overwhelm your dopamine system by also scrolling or playing games on your computer.



TIP #5: MEALS > SNACKS

Every TikTok, Reel, or short video is a tiny **dopamine snack**. It tastes good for a second but it **wrecks** your appetite for real focus. Your brain gets so used to **rapid-fire** hits that anything slow – like homework, reading, or a real conversation – can't **compete** anymore. That sucks.

Long form content is a dopamine meal. A YouTube video, a podcast, a movie – these train your brain to stay with something and find the reward at the end. That patience is the exact skill you need for everything hard in life.

REAL LIFE EXAMPLES MEALS > SNACKS

Instead of 'snacking' on TikTok for 10 minutes, eat a 'meal' and watch a 10-minute YouTube video with minimal editing.

Instead of Snapchatting everyone people back when you wake up, put on a podcast while you get ready for the day.

Sounds cringe, but to be successful you've got to be willing to be cringe.

TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

Pick one long form thing to consume today instead of short form. A YouTube video, a podcast episode, a documentary. Notice how you feel after.

Set a short form limit – 15 minutes max per day this week. Use the screen time limit on your phone to enforce it.

Next time you feel the scroll trap pulling you in, ask yourself: **am I snacking or eating a meal?** Then choose intentionally!



TIP #6: THE SIX S'S TO SUCCESS

I've noticed when I do three or four of these things every day, **I feel locked in and unstoppable**. The Six S's to Success aren't extras. They're the foundation.

Prioritize them and everything else **falls into place**.

Confidence, motivation, focus, good results... you name it!
If there's any tip that's **most important**, I'd consider it this one.

WHAT ARE THE SIX S'S TO SUCCESS?

Sleep – Your dopamine system resets overnight. This is non-negotiable. Shoot for 7–9 hours.

Sunlight – Get outside and touch grass! More sunlight is proven to make you happier.

Sip – Drink water. Dehydration tanks focus, mood, and energy faster than almost anything else.

Sweat – Exercise is one of the most powerful natural dopamine boosters. Movement = medicine!

Scrolling – Limit it. You already know why. (See Tip 5.)

Sugar – High sugar spikes dopamine fast and crashes it hard. The afternoon slump you feel? Often sugar.

TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

Score yourself on the 6 S's today. How many did you nail? How many did you skip? Start there.

Pick the one S you're worst at and focus on just that one this week. Don't try to fix all six at once.

Stack two S's together!! Go for a walk outside with a water bottle. Sunlight, sweat, and sip in one walk.



TIP #7: TIME YOUR HITS

Your dopamine system runs on a rhythm. Blow it up at the wrong time and you're either starting the day already crashed or destroying your ability to sleep. Most people (including me sometimes!) are doing both.. **phone first thing in the morning and phone last thing at night.**

That's your dopamine working against you before the day even starts. You don't need to quit your phone. **You just need to be smarter about when you use it.** Time your hits right and your whole day works better.

REAL LIFE EXAMPLES TO TIME YOUR HITS

Instead of waking up and checking your phone right away, **get ready** for school, eat a good breakfast, THEN check your phone.

Instead of spiking your dopamine with video games after school. Do your homework THEN use video games as a **reward** for getting them done.

Instead of scrolling until 1 a.m., **read a book** or listen to a podcast until you fall asleep. It's much, much better for you and your brain.

Note: If these sound boring and lame, these tips are especially for you lol. Your dopamine system is out of whack and it's time to lock in.

TRY THESE THINGS THIS WEEK

Don't touch your phone for the first 30 minutes after waking up. Sunlight, water, and food first. Phone second.

No screens after 10pm. Dim your lights, put the phone down, and let your dopamine settle before sleep.

Earn your dopamine hits. Save the scroll, the games, and the shows for after the work is done. Reward yourself intentionally.